

Audit Evidence Ledger for AI-Assisted Accounting Workflows

• Audit

• Assurance

Full paper: 15 min read
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THE QUESTION

How can audit teams reconstruct what supported an AI-assisted answer?

THE SHORT ANSWER

An AI-assisted answer is only as defensible as the record behind it. An evidence ledger records each event (request, sources, answer, controls, review, outcome, export) with review states, integrity properties and complete exports, so that an auditor can reconstruct a decision without relying on a chat transcript.

FOUR KEY IDEAS

1 Chat is not evidence

Transcripts are editable, incomplete and detached from sources, versions and decisions. Evidence records show what happened, in order, and who decided.

2 Capture events and states

Request, sources, answer, controls, review, outcome and export, with review states preserved so the position at any date can be reconstructed.

3 Trust comes from how it is kept

Append-only behavior, tamper evidence, access control, segregation of duties and deliberate retention, reconciled with privacy obligations.

4 Exports must prove completeness

Filters, counts, stable identifiers and a statement of what was left out. A partial export that looks complete is worse than none.

WHO SHOULD READ THE FULL PAPER

Audit and assurance leaders, internal audit and risk teams, controllers and AI governance owners who must be able to explain, after the fact, how an AI-assisted answer came to be.

INSIDE THE FULL PAPER

What the full paper covers

#	SECTION	WHAT IT ANSWERS
1	Why reconstructability matters	If you cannot reconstruct how an answer was produced, you cannot defend it.
2	Anatomy of an evidence record	A record is a sequence of events, each capturing one thing that happened.
3	Review states	Evidence is not only what happened. It is the state of the answer at each point in time.
4	Integrity, retention and access	A record is only useful if it can be trusted and found. Trust is a property of how it is kept.
5	Evidence exports	An export is where the ledger meets the audit. It must be complete, and it must show that it is.
6	How audit teams use the ledger	Four uses, each testing a different part of the control environment over AI-assisted work.
7	A worked example: reconstructing one answer	What an auditor actually does with a record, step by step. The example is generic and illustrative.
8	An evidence-readiness checklist	Twelve questions to put to any vendor, and to your own organization, before relying on AI-assisted work.

QUESTIONS THIS PAPER HELPS YOU ASK

☐	Does every answer produce a record, including escalations and rejections?
☐	Are sources recorded with versions and effective dates?
☐	Are reviewer, decision and time recorded at each state change?
☐	Can alteration of a record be detected?
☐	Does an export show what was and was not included?

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